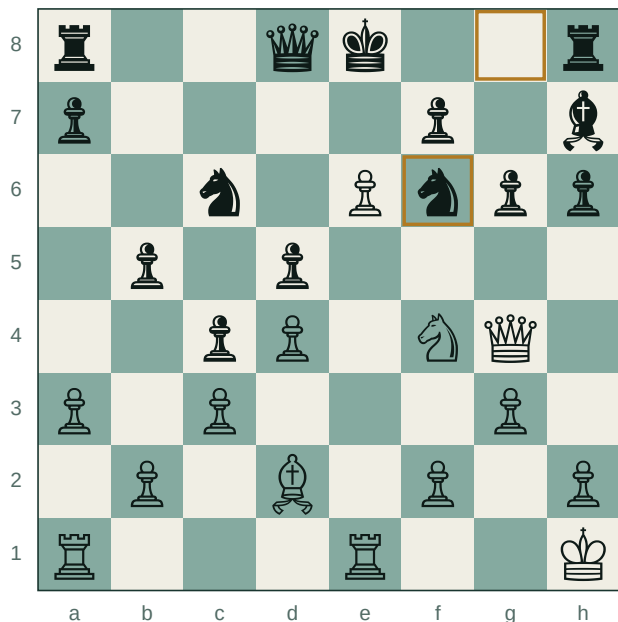


Double checks: White, move 18

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 17...Nf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. exf7+ Kxf7 19. Qe6+ Kg7 20. Qxc6

18.exf7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the king on e8. Recorded reply: **18...Kxf7**.

19.Qe6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on f7, knight on f6 and knight on c6. Recorded reply: **19...Kg7**.

20.Qxc6 The queen captures the knight on c6. From c6 it attacks rook on a8 and knight on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and knight on c6. Check for tactical protection.